- `"Development"`
- `"Staging"`
- `"Production"`

ASP.NET Core includes several helper methods for working with these three values, so you'll have an easier time if you stick to them. In particular, whenever you're testing whether your app is running in a particular environment, you should use one of the following extension methods:

- `IHostEnvironment.IsDevelopment()`
- `IHostEnvironment.IsStaging()`
- `IHostEnvironment.IsProduction()`
- `IHostEnvironment.IsEnvironment(string environmentName)`

All these methods make sure that they do case-insensitive checks of the environment variable, so you won't get any wonky errors at runtime if you don't capitalize the environment variable value.

TIP Where possible, use the `IHostEnvironment` extension methods instead of direct string comparison with `EnvironmentName`, as the methods provide case-insensitive matching.

`IHostEnvironment` doesn't do anything other than expose the details of your current environment, but you can use it in various ways. In chapter 4 you saw that `WebApplication` adds the `DeveloperExceptionMiddleware` to your middleware pipeline only in the development environment. Now you know where `WebApplication` was getting its information about the environment: `IHostEnvironment`.